



Develop conference programs

D2.TCS.CL5.09

Assessor Manual



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Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: DEVELOP CONFERENCE PROGRAMS		NOMINAL HOURS: 40
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TCS.CL5.09		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to design a conference program to suit the requirements of a client.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Meet with conference organiser 1.1 Identify <i>timing requirements</i> for conference 1.2 Determine <i>type, context and scope</i> for conference 1.3 Determine <i>budget</i> for the conference 1.4 Determine <i>catering needs</i> for the conference 1.5 Determine <i>accommodation needs</i> for the conference 1.6 Determine <i>if the conference can be accommodated</i> 1.7 Submit <i>draft proposal and indicative quotation</i> to client 1.8 Book the conference with suitable suppliers and service providers		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to the development of conference programs where the business acts as an agent for the client and liaises with service providers/suppliers, such as accommodation venues, caterers, entertainers and convention facilities within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Timing requirements</i> may be related to: • Start and finish date(s) • Duration including start and finish times of conference components such as meals, breaks, activities, special events and free time allocations • Identification of alternative times and dates, where applicable.

Element 2: Plan the conference program in conjunction with the client 2.1 Assist client to <i>develop conference format</i> 2.2 Identify <i>allocation of facilities to the conference</i> 2.3 Assist in <i>developing theme</i> for the conference 2.4 Identify <i>specific requirements</i> from identified general requirements 2.5 Maintain <i>on-going liaison</i> with client 2.6 Address issues arising in the planning of the conference 2.7 Determine <i>notifications</i> for the conference 2.8 Arrange for <i>venue facilities to be available</i> to the client Element 3: Finalise conference program 3.1 Develop and submit final proposal and quotation 3.2 Negotiate <i>finalisation of the conference</i> with client 3.3 Obtain <i>binding confirmation</i> of the conference from the client 3.4 Confirm <i>conference details</i> with suppliers and providers 3.5 Begin <i>activities in accordance with approved proposal/plan</i>	<i>Determine type, context and scope for conference will include:</i> • Identifying the type of conference required by the client including conferences for single organisation, multiple-user conferences and identification of the focus and objectives for the conference • Identifying information relating to the format and conduct for the conference, including identification of: ▪ Workshops ▪ Plenary sessions ▪ Break-out sessions ▪ Key note and support speakers ▪ Facilitators ▪ Entertainment ▪ Theme(s) for the conference ▪ Required and/or preferred conference policies, procedures and protocols ▪ Requirements for registration of delegates including consideration of supply of name tags, pens, paper conference bags and similar ▪ Media involvement in the conference, if any ▪ Security requirements ▪ Parking requirements ▪ Exhibitors ▪ Activities to be undertaken during or as part of the conference including touring, sight-seeing, entertainment at other venues, involvement of third party activity providers ▪ Possible involvement of external third party providers as required by the client, for example: flower displays, information technology services, security
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	▪ Room layout including head tables, seating for conference delegates, required displays, presentation facilities and other requirements to specific conference types and client needs ▪ Staging requirements including identification of technical needs for the conference • Identifying conference numbers including profile of those who will be attending and arrangements/identification of numbers attending nominated sessions • Arranging for a guided tour of identified facilities including all room/venue options and an explanation of suitability for identified aspects of the conference • Providing client with a conference kit from suppliers including capacity charts to indicate room/venue capacities and seating options, photographs or video of past conferences, testimonies from past clients • Inviting relevant managers and staff from venues to the discussion with the client. <i>Determine budget</i> may include: • Identifying initial budget parameters as stated by the client • Identifying client expectations for the budget available • Identifying products and services that are acceptable as on-charges • Identifying items which delegates are expected to pay for • Identifying physical, human and technical resources provided by the client to assist in controlling expenses • Negotiating prices including determination of relevant discounts or deals, such as meeting packages that may apply to the client • Explaining limitations that will apply based on the identified budget as nominated by the client • Suggesting cost-effective alternatives to meet budget limitations and enhance the provision of the conference.
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	<i>Determine catering needs</i> should include: • Considering all food and beverage requirements, alcoholic and non-alcoholic, hot and cold, for conference delegates which may include: ▪ On arrival requirements, such as tea, coffee, pastries, fruit, cakes ▪ During-conference refreshments, such as water and mints ▪ Catering requirements at break times ▪ Meals including consideration of breakfast, lunch and dinner and identification of the level of formality of each meal ▪ Supper ▪ Cocktails ▪ Dances and social sessions • Identifying food and beverages to be supplied to media, where applicable • Identifying special food and beverage requests including preferences, religious concerns and health related requirements • Identifying various food and beverage service options and styles of service • Identifying timing requirements for food and beverage delivery and duration of service • Identifying limitations that apply to 'free bar' facilities, if applicable • Meeting with chefs from venues to obtain their input • Arranging for a variety of food, drinks and wine menus at a variety of price points, including taste tests, where appropriate • Explaining the advantages and disadvantages of various catering options, in terms of time, cost, room use, social interaction and networking.
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	<i>Accommodation needs</i> should relate to: • Delegate needs • Partners of delegates • Media • Use of day-use rooms • Use of baggage and other storage rooms • Determining the ancillary items that are to be included in accommodation charges, including meals, entertainment, transfers and special use of establishment facilities • Numbers and types of rooms required • Date(s) accommodation is required • Preferences for grouping conference delegates together • Identifying in-room facilities required by delegates • Identifying in-house support services required by delegates including functions, laundry, security, transport, spa and nominated other facilities. <i>Determine if the conference can be accommodated</i> may include: • Checking with established providers to identify availability of required rooms and facilities • Sourcing new service providers to accommodate conference needs • Identifying, investigating and costing external service provision requirements that are required to service the conference. <i>Submit draft proposal and indicative quotation</i> may include: • Conducting supplementary meetings with client to clarify requirements and issues • Seeking quotations from providers/suppliers including the determination of commissions involved and/or charges for services to be made
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	• Organising and providing samples of products from suppliers, as required • Making presentations to the client at their premises/business including involvement of manager(s) and staff from suppliers/providers • Clarifying ambiguous requirements • Preparing a formal proposal for submission to client that specifies the goods and services to be delivered including names and contact details of anticipated and/or alternative providers, where applicable, plus service delivery standards that can be expected • Providing prices for individual elements of the conference as requested by the client together with a final price for the conference • Identifying items that are to be regarded as add-on costs to be charged on a fee-for-service basis as used by the conference • Identifying non-negotiable and negotiable price-related items • Identifying requirements for securing a booking including payment related details and timelines that apply to final notification of numbers attending, food and beverage menu selections and final room set-ups • Communicating the terms and conditions of trade for all suppliers/providers and for the agency relating to cancellations, charges, invoicing and general conditions, such as smoking, access and other as appropriate • Meeting with the client to explain the proposal and quotation as opposed to simply supplying the proposal and quotation without comment • Ensuring the proposal and quotation are identified as draft and indicative including a statement that a final proposal and quotation will be supplied when outstanding matters have been finalised and that prices are subject to change without notice. <i>Develop conference format may include:</i> • Assisting in creating the final structure and sequence of conference sessions • Engaging in on-going liaison with service providers/suppliers
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	• Identifying the timing and facility requirements for conference options including break-out and other sessions • Suggesting and/or presenting format options to client where requested to do so • Confirming catering requirements for each stage of the conference including notification to suppliers • Verifying previously stated and identified requirements including revising and amending as required • Confirming accommodation and other room/facility use requirements for the conference with suppliers/providers • Firming up delegate numbers and notifying suppliers/providers • Making final decisions in relation to identified speakers, entertainment, conference-related activities, free time activities, tours and sight-seeing. <i>Allocation of facilities to the conference may include:</i> • Determining the suppliers/venues who may be involved in service provision/delivery • Blocking room numbers in accommodation facilities for the period of the conference, as required • Booking conference facilities and other allied requirements for the conference • Filing booking notifications and confirmations from suppliers/providers • Advising client of progress with the plans and bookings for the conference • Liaising with client and suppliers/providers to determine the most appropriate and effective use of the limited establishment facilities that exist. <i>Assist in developing theme may include:</i> • Making suggestions and recommendations in conjunction with suppliers/providers • Undertaking additional site tours of suppliers/providers with the client
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	• Providing details of previous conferences at potential suppliers/providers to assist with client decision making • Advising the client where themes are unlikely to work. <i>Identify specific requirements</i> may include: • Quantifying specific materials required to produce or construct required staging, displays and other identified necessities • Identifying specific types of equipment required to support nominated activities and requirements • Identifying specific brands of products as preferred by the client • Fine-tuning the numbers and general conference requirements including releasing blocked rooms back onto the board for sale • Determining final room set-ups for individual sessions including consideration of various styles including theatre, boardroom, u-shape, dinner, dinner dance and cocktails sessions • Notifying suppliers/providers of information obtained from client. <i>Maintain on-going liaison</i> may include: • Providing contact details to the client • Being available at times and locations to suit client need • Scheduling meetings to discuss and resolve conference matters • Providing hard copies of decisions that have been taken, or advised, verbally • Maintaining a conference file of all documentation and decisions relating to the conference including communications from suppliers/providers • Speaking to client nominated groups on behalf of the client organiser to explain matters and provide required information
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	• Acting as an advocate for the client when representing their interests to providers/suppliers • Working on behalf of the client to achieve their stated objectives. <i>Determine notifications</i> may include: • Identifying the role of the business in notifying conference delegates regarding the conference • Identifying the role of the business in accepting bookings and registrations including deposits and payments, where applicable for the conference • Advertising the conference on the business website including password protected access to relevant sections, as required by the client • Issuing media statements in relation to the conference including pre-conference, during conference and post-conference releases • Developing a standard media kit for the conference • Direct mailing conference material to delegates as nominated by the client • Passing on registration and allied details to the client on a regular basis. <i>Arrange for venue facilities to be available</i> may include: • Liaising with client and providers/suppliers to facilitate inspection of the property and venue facilities for planning purposes • Assisting client with their plans relating to positioning of items within conference rooms and identified venues • Arranging for client to experience and sample the facilities, services and products of the suppliers/providers including provision of complementary meals, accommodation, food/drinks, entertainment and other services as deemed relevant to the requirements of the proposed conference.
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	<i>Negotiate finalisation of the conference</i> may include: • Meeting with suppliers/providers and the client to confirm final proposal and quotation • Negotiating prices with client and/or suppliers/providers • Suggesting substitutions and alternatives for items deemed by the client to be inappropriate or too expensive • Achieving a win-win situation for the business, suppliers/providers and the client • Identifying the selling price below which the conference will not be accepted • Refusing/regretting the conference if a viable selling price cannot be agreed. <i>Obtain binding confirmation</i> may include: • Signing of a contract • Obtaining payment of a deposit. <i>Confirm conference details</i> may include: • Notifying venues in relation to confirmation of the conference • Making payments to identified venues, suppliers and service providers to formalise the conference booking • Advising relevant personnel in relation to next steps to be taken regarding implementation of the conference • Seeking verification that all bookings that have been made are confirmed. <i>Begin activities in accordance with approved proposal/plan</i> may include: • Communicating with suppliers/service providers and organising products and services to be provided by them, where required • Initiating action within the business to coincide with planned timelines to facilitate effective and successful delivery of the conference by the identified suppliers/providers.
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Assessment Guide

The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:

- Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to meetings, incentives conferences and exhibitions (MICE) as well as all related issues such as service delivery, terms and conditions, payment, security, and interaction with the media
- Principles of catering and food and beverage service options
- Knowledge of typical conference formats
- Knowledge of general client expectations in relation to conferences and their delivery
- Knowledge of the host establishment including layout, products and services available
- Knowledge of products and services that can be obtained for inclusion in the provision of a conference at the host establishment
- Ability to use selling, communication, negotiation and interpersonal skills
- Ability to prepare proposals and quotations
- General industry knowledge
- Knowledge of the range of options available for staging and room set-ups.

Linkages To Other Units

- Source and package tourism products and services
- Plan, manage and conduct meetings
- Organise and prepare food products and services
- Work effectively with colleagues and customers
- Apply basic techniques of commercial cookery
- Develop and maintain food and beverage product knowledge
- Provide food and beverage services

	• Promote products and services to customers • Prepare and deliver a presentation • Book and coordinate supplier services • Manage contractual agreements/commitments. Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of host agency policies and procedures in regard to meetings, incentives conferences and exhibitions (MICE) as well as all related issues such as service delivery, terms and conditions, payment, security and interaction with the media • Demonstrated ability to meet with a real or simulated conference organiser to develop a conference program which must include: ▪ Identification of dates(s), times and budget limitations ▪ Identification of nature, context, format and objectives ▪ Identification of catering and accommodation requirements ▪ Preparation of a written proposal: – Identifying by name the venue(s) that can deliver the identified requirements, including evidence of their ability to do so – Identifying by name all ancillary service providers required to supplement the services, products and facilities available from the primary venue(s) – Describing an appropriate theme for the conference ▪ Preparation of a formal written quotation, including relevant terms and conditions that supports the proposal. Context of Assessment Assessment must ensure: • Actual or simulated workplace application of planning activities which may include visits to venues, suppliers and service providers.
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	Resource Implications Training and assessment must include a real or simulated conference development context, including real or simulated conference requirements, real venues, real suppliers and real service providers.		
	Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Portfolio of documentation developed as part of the planning process including letters/e-mails requesting information from providers, information supplied by providers, draft and final proposals and quotations, records of meetings with the client and conference details/requirements furnished by the client • Feedback from the real or simulated conference organiser, suppliers and other relevant participants in the planning process • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.		
	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	1	Obtain conference details and requirements from the conference organiser

	Communicating ideas and information	2	Making suggestions and recommendations to the client in relation to venues, suppliers and service providers
	Planning and organising activities	3	Organising bookings and activities with venues, suppliers and service providers; scheduling meetings with client
	Working with others and in teams	2	Cooperating with venues, suppliers and service providers to produce an acceptable conference proposal
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	2	Calculating costs
	Solving problems	2	Resolving planning issues as they arise
	Using technology	1	Using the internet to research potential venues, suppliers and service providers and communicate with client

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop conference programs D2.TCS.CL5.09
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Tell me about a situation where you have met with a client to identify needs for a conference program; how did you determine timing requirements, type, context and scope?	☐	☐
2. For the event identified in your previous answer, what did you do to determine budget and catering requirements?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. What were the accommodation requirements for the conference identified in your last answer? How were these identified/calculated and how did you determine if these needs could be met?	☐	☐
4. Describe a draft proposal and quotation you have developed for a conference for a client.	☐	☐
5. Name a conference you have been involved with and describe the booking and use of third party suppliers to organise and deliver parts of the event.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. Tell me about a conference you have planned and describe how you assisted the client with deciding the format for the event, allocating facilities, developing a theme and identifying specific requirements.	☐	☐
7. For the conference identified in your previous answer how did you ensure you maintained effective ongoing liaison with the client?	☐	☐
8. Give me an example of an issue that arose for one of the conferences identified and explain how you address it/responded.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. What notifications were needed for the conference identified in the last answer? How were these determined?	☐	☐
10. In general terms what is involved in arranging venue facilities to be available to the client for inspection, preparation and/or use?	☐	☐
11. Tell me about a final proposal and quotation you have developed for a conference program: what was it? What was involved? What did you do? What was in the final documentation?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Describe with reference to an example to illustrate your response how you negotiated finalisation of a conference program with a client, obtained their binding confirmation of arrangements and confirmed details with suppliers and providers.	☐	☐
13. What are the general activities involved in initiating activities for a conference program?	☐	☐

Written questions

Develop conference programs – D2.TCS.CL5.09

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What does the acronym 'MICE' stand for?

2. Give four reasons a travel agency/tour operator seeks to be involved in developing conference programs.

3. What factors would you take into account when arranging the first face-to-face meeting with a conference organiser?

4. Give four time-related details/issues which need to be identified for a conference.

5. Identify four ways to identify the main requirements and context for a conference.

6. What is a 'project brief'?

7. Describe four matters which need to be discussed, requirements identified and (where applicable) quantified when meeting with a conference organiser to determine type, context and scope for the conference.

8. In relation to conferences, what is 'sponsorship'?

9. Give two reasons the budget for the conference needs to be identified and clarified as part of the initial meeting with the conference organiser.

10. List four generic topics to discuss when determining budget/s for a conference.

11. Identify five **basic details** which need to be identified for **all catering requirements** for a conference.

12. Name four topics to address when discussing catering requirements for a conference.

13. Name four topics (**apart from date-related information**) which need to be addressed when talking to a conference organiser about the number of accommodation rooms they want for a conference.

14. Describe date-related information required when discussing 'accommodation required' with a conference organiser.

15. Give four possible uses for 'rooms' at a conference apart from accommodation of delegates.

16. What is the basis for determining whether or not a conference can be accommodated?

17. What is the role of a 'tentative booking' in relation to booking conferences with venues/providers?

18. What three factors determine the contents of a Draft Proposal to a conference organiser for a conference?

19. Give four details regarding the role of the Draft Proposal.

20. Identify eight topics which may comprise the content of a Draft proposal for a conference.

21. Name three requirements which should be inherent in the process of obtaining quotations from potential venues/providers for a conference.

22. Name four activities which may be involved in preparing the Draft Proposal for a conference.

23. Give four examples of SOPs/activities required before a Draft Proposal is released to the client for their consideration.

24. Name six activities involved as part of planning/preparation and delivery process of making the presentation of a Draft Proposal to the conference organiser.

25. Give three ways a client might give authority to proceed with a conference following presentation of a Draft proposal.

26. What are the two things most travel agencies/tour operators require before they are prepared to proceed with a conference?

27. List four activities which follow when the authority to proceed with the Draft Proposal has been given by the client.

28. What are the four basic options in relation to helping the conference organiser develop a conference program?

29. Name six common format options for conference sessions.

30. Describe six generic activities involved in developing a conference program.

31. Activities inherent in identifying the allocation of facilities to the conference will vary depending on certain factors: name four of these.

32. Identify six activities involved in identification of facilities for a conference.

33. Describe the role of a theme in relation to conducting a conference.

34. Give six 'important factors' relating to the theme/s for a conference.

35. List six strategies to identify ideas for themes for a conference.

36. Name four topics which need to be considered when identifying specific requirements for a conference from identified general requirements.

37. List four practical fundamentals of maintaining on-going liaison with the client/conference organiser.

38. Identify two issues which might arise during the planning of a conference and illustrate how each might be a 'positive' and a 'negative' issue.

39. Name four pieces of advice to help deal with issues arising during the planning of a conference.

40. Name four generic types of notifications which might need to occur with reference to an upcoming conference.

41. What are the four main communication options for making notifications with reference to an upcoming conference?

42. Give six keys relating to notifications for a conference.

43. Name four generic activities involved in arranging for facilities to be available for a client/conference.

44. Identify four points which need to be afforded due attention in relation to preparing a Final Proposal and quotation for a conference.

45. Name six activities and content which are indicative of what may need to be involved in developing and submitting a Final Proposal for a conference.

46. Provide six examples of important background advice in relation to negotiating finalisation of the contract/conference with a client/conference organiser.

47. Give six examples of strategies which might be employed to secure a conference.

48. What are the two keys to obtaining binding confirmation of a conference from a conference organiser?

49. What are four possible ancillary issues which might need to be addressed when confirming conference details with a venue/provider?

50. Describe four keys to beginning action in relation to a conference which has been approved by a conference organiser.

Answers to written questions

Develop conference programs – D2.TCS.CL5.09

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. What does the acronym 'MICE' stand for?
 - M = Meetings
 - I – Incentives
 - C = Conventions or Conferences
 - E = Exhibitions or Events.
2. Give four reasons a travel agency/tour operator seeks to be involved in developing conference programs.
 - A desire to increase market share – in terms of travel and/or tours
 - Need to diversify current operations – and become involved in related industry sectors as indicated by internal Strategic plans
 - Need to match what their opposition is doing – where/if competitors are entering this market space
 - Strategic action to become aligned/associated with a nominated activity, enterprise, organisation, industry or initiative – to enhance the reputation of the business or to re-position it in the eyes of the public.
3. What factors would you take into account when arranging the first face-to-face meeting with a conference organiser?
 - Place/location for the meeting – with effort aimed at the travel agency/tour operator or a possible venue/conference facility: client may dictate location
 - Duration – aiming for a 4-hour meeting perhaps including a meal: client may dictate duration and start/finish times
 - Date for the meeting
 - Who will attend/participate.
4. Give four time-related details/issues which need to be identified for a conference.
 - Start date for the conference
 - Finish date for the conference
 - Travel dates
 - Dates and duration (start and finish times) of conference components
 - Identification of alternative times and dates, where applicable.

5. Identify four ways to identify the main requirements and context for a conference.

- Reading a pre-prepared brief.
- Listening to what the client/conference organiser has to say
- Asking questions to elicit further detail
- Taking notes.

6. What is a 'project brief'?

- A project brief is a written/hard copy documents prepared and provided by the client/conference organiser setting out their conference requirements and the constraints/limits that apply.

7. Describe four matters which need to be discussed, requirements identified and (where applicable) quantified when meeting with a conference organiser to determine type, context and scope for the conference.

- User/s
- Type of event required
- Nature of event required
- Budget
- Catering
- Accommodation
- Conference objective/s
- Attendees/audiences
- Format
- Themes
- Branding
- Sponsors/sponsorship
- Exhibitors/stands/displays
- Assistance with visa applications
- Media involvement
- Security
- Parking
- Support services and personnel
- Transfers to and from the conference
- Requirements for registration of delegates
- Activities to be undertaken during or as part of the conference
- Room layouts for each session
- Conference protocols.

8. In relation to conferences, what is 'sponsorship'?
- Sponsorship relates to obtaining support (usually financial, but it can include 'in kind support – such as products to give away, help from staff from other businesses, joint advertising, assistance with selling tickets) for the conference.
9. Give two reasons the budget for the conference needs to be identified and clarified as part of the initial meeting with the conference organiser.
- Help determine the viability of the work – from the perspective of the employer so they can work out what resources (staff, time) to commit
 - Evaluate or whether or not the event is worth pursuing – or if the conference should be 'regretted' (refused)
 - Ensure the client is aware of the current costs attaching to what it is they want to conduct/achieve.
10. List four generic topics to discuss when determining budget/s for a conference.
- Identifying initial budget parameters
 - Identifying client expectations
 - Identifying products and services acceptable as on-charges
 - Identifying items delegates are expected to pay for
 - Identifying resources to be provided by the client to assist in controlling expenses
 - Negotiating prices
 - Explaining limitations
 - Suggesting cost-effective alternatives.
11. Identify five basic details which need to be identified for all catering requirements for a conference.
- Days/dates required
 - Time allowed/available – start time of service, duration of service
 - Numbers who need to be catered for
 - An idea of the location where the catering is required/needs to be provided
 - Budget for catering – and/or nominated catering aspects of the conference.

12. Name four topics to address when discussing catering requirements for a conference.

- On-arrival requirements
- During-conference refreshments
- Catering requirements at break times
- Meals – all types
- Special events
- Beverages
- Media considerations
- Special food and beverage needs and/or requests
- Maximum and minimum numbers and payments
- Taste tests and sample menus/items
- Differentiate between available catering and service options

13. Name four topics (apart from date-related information) which need to be addressed when talking to a conference organiser about the number of accommodation rooms they want for a conference.

- Number of rooms required on a daily basis
- Price being charged to delegates by the conference organiser and/or budget for rooming/accommodation.
- Sleeping configuration of rooms required by the conference organiser
- Standard of rooms and facilities required
- Numbers of VIPs
- Rooms required for media representatives

14. Describe date-related information required when discussing 'accommodation required' with a conference organiser.

- Dates rooms required
- Cross-referenced to days of week
- Cross-referenced against types and numbers of rooms
- Cross-referenced against facilities/standards required.

15. Give four possible uses for 'rooms' at a conference apart from accommodation of delegates.

- Day-use rooms – for a variety of reasons/uses:
 - As change room for presenters and others
 - As media rooms – to facilitate lodgement of stories by media
 - As a control point – to give location where key personnel can be found
 - As a 'quiet room' – a retreat for key conference organisers
 - As a waiting room – prior to presentations
- Rooms required for baggage rooms – to:
 - Store equipment and items for the conference
 - Allow exhibitors to store their stock
 - Stow empty luggage for delegates
- Rooms required for specific 'other uses' – such as:
 - Displays
 - Private talks and discussions
 - Retail sales
 - Private demonstrations.

16. What is the basis for determining whether or not a conference can be accommodated?

- Determining if the conference can be accommodated or not refers to the practice of identifying whether the city has the resources available at the time and in the quantities required to deliver/house the conference.
- It means working out:
 - If the required accommodation is available in suitable venues on the identified dates within the budget allocated
 - Whether delegates and others attending the conference can be carried to and from the conference on the required dates within the budget allocated
 - If the identified catering can be delivered as and when required and in the volumes necessary within the budget allocated.

17. What is the role of a 'tentative booking' in relation to booking conferences with venues/providers?

- Tentative bookings are made:
 - If the venue or operator is able to and wants to accommodate/cater for the conference
 - If the conference organiser agrees the venue/operator is a suitable provider.
- Making a tentative booking 'locks them in' for a given/short period until a final decision is made about the conference and ensures their products and services are available when and as required if the conference organiser agrees to proceed and use them.

18. What three factors determine the contents of a Draft Proposal to a conference organiser for a conference?

- The standard template (pro forma) used by the business for providing Draft Proposals to clients – some businesses will address topics not covered by other operators
- Requirements of the client and arrangements made with them about what needs to be addressed – some conference organisers want more detail than others on certain aspects
- The nature, style and scope of the individual conference to which the Draft Proposal applies – each conference is unique and the requirements for each one are specific to their identified needs, wants and preferences.

19. Give four details regarding the role of the Draft Proposal.

The 'Draft Proposal':

- Proves to the client/conference organiser the travel agent/tour operator is serious about assisting with the conference – and wants to form a business relationship with the client
- Demonstrates the commitment the business has made to the client and the value they place on this opportunity – by showing evidence of having understood their needs and through providing tangible proof time and money has already been spent on behalf of the client
- Is a formal document – provided by the travel agent/tour operator to the conference organiser
- Is 'Proof of Concept' – it confirms the conference can be provided according to the requirements discussed with the conference organiser
- Suggests the businesses who will be involved in enabling the conference – and the products and services they will provide
- Forms the basis of further discussions with the conference organiser.

20. Identify eight topics which may comprise the content of a Draft proposal for a conference.

- Dates and times – of:
 - The conference
 - Specified elements of same
- Names of suggested carriers – with:
 - Suggested flight numbers
 - Dates and times:
 - Inbound and outbound
 - Departure and arrival
 - Sample itinerary
 - Travel insurance options
 - Overview of immigration and customs requirements
- Names of suggested venues/providers – with:
 - Their location
 - Rooms available – with details of venue and room facilities
 - Room rates
 - Goods and services they can provide – such as transfers, security, AV and IT, parking, advertising and promotion
 - Catering details – including sample menus for drinks and dishes at required or various price points
 - Dates by which tentative bookings need to be confirmed
- An indicative quotation for the conference – broken down into relevant sections or as otherwise agreed with the conference organiser
- A brief indication of suggestions/thoughts for the conference program – which may address issues relating to:
 - Format and structure
 - Content and inclusions
 - Themes and messages
 - Sequencing and integration of activities
 - Promotion, sponsorship and bookings.
- A statement highlighting:
 - The proposal and quotations are draft and indicative only
 - A final proposal and quotation will be supplied when outstanding matters have been finalised
 - Prices are, as appropriate:
 - Fixed to a given date, or
 - Subject to change without notice

21. Name three requirements which should be inherent in the process of obtaining quotations from potential venues/providers for a conference.

- Obtain quotes only from suitable providers/venues – and not from those which may be too expensive/excess in terms of quality, or from those who are insufficiently able to meet the identified requirements, standards or service criteria
- Secure the quotations in writing so they are available to show the client, and can be referred to
- Identify potential additional fees, charges and on-costs
- Identify booking, notification and payment requirements
- Determine commissions payable.

22. Name four activities which may be involved in preparing the Draft Proposal for a conference.

- Address all issues – identified as being necessary or of concern to the client
- Name the suppliers, providers and venues being put forward as options for final selection
- Specify the goods and services to be delivered by individual venues and businesses – including:
 - Brand names of products to be used
 - Sample menus
 - Sample room set-ups
 - Conditions of Use – of certain areas with reference to issues such as smoking, behaviour, noise, access arrangements/restrictions, bans on affixing posters/things to walls, time allowed for set-up and take-down of the conference
 - Terms of Trade and invoicing
 - Warranties and Guarantees which are applicable
- Give names and contact details of listed providers
- Indicate expected/promised service delivery standards stated by each business
- Show costs/prices for each supplier, provider and venue for the goods and services they will provide
- Specify and quantify items that are to be regarded as add-on costs to be charged on a fee-for-service basis as used by the conference
- Identify non-negotiable and negotiable price-related items
- Detail requirements necessary to convert tentative bookings into confirmed reservations – with reference to:
 - Date/s for booking confirmation to secure prices/deals quoted
 - Payment required – deposit, progress payments and/or final payment
 - Dates when final numbers are required
- Give a final 'indicative' price for the Draft Proposal.

23. Give four examples of SOPs/activities required before a Draft Proposal is released to the client for their consideration.

- Meeting with Management, the Sales and/or Finance department to explain the Proposal to them – this:
 - Gives an opportunity for others to read the document and identify errors and omissions
 - Provides an opportunity for constructive feedback
- Allows practice for presenting the Draft Proposal to the client
- Revising the document – as required on the basis of comments received and directions from management
- Obtaining approval from management – for release of the Draft Proposal
- Filing a copy of the approved Draft – for future reference
- Producing multiple hard copies of the Draft Proposal – there will always be a need for more than one copy.

Regardless of electronic copies, there needs to be one hard copy for:

- Every person who is 'conference organiser'
- Those identified as key stakeholders/decision makers
- Each person who is known to be attending the presentation of the Draft Proposal
- Spare
- Forwarding the Draft Proposal to the conference organiser – standard procedure can vary between businesses (and needs to factor in client preferences), for example:
 - Local/domestic clients may be sent, by courier, several hard copies – supplemented by email attachment/s
 - Overseas clients may receive *only* an electronic file – or they may be provided with a hard copy through arrangements with an agency/business in that country
 - The client may state they want/prefer soft copy
- Arranging time, date and location for making a face-to-face presentation of the Draft Proposal – so required explanation can be made and client questions can be addressed.

24. Name six activities involved as part of planning/preparation and delivery process of making the presentation of a Draft Proposal to the conference organiser.

- Arranging for catering for the presentation – this may be ‘refreshments’, a meal or sample foods listed in the proposal
- Arranging for ‘relevant others’ to be in attendance – to:
 - Demonstrate the importance the business places on the client
 - Enable those with expertise to answer questions
- Setting-up/preparing the venue for the meeting – DVDs, chairs, brochures, screens
- Rehearsing the presentation
- Being suitable dressed and arriving early
- Explaining and expanding on each part of the Proposal
- Identifying and practicing responses to problems and objections
- Welcoming attendees
- Thanking them for their time and the opportunity
- Taking notes of questions for later follow-up – if they cannot be resolved/answered at the time.

25. Give three ways a client might give authority to proceed with a conference following presentation of a Draft proposal.

- Verbal approval and acceptance of the Draft Proposal – or a revised Proposal.
 - Simple verbal acceptance is often all that is needed where the client is known to the agency/operator and/or they are a repeat client.
- A signed document/contract – legally committing the client to the agreed/negotiated terms contained.
 - In these cases there may, or may not, be a requirement for payment of some monies to accompany the signing of the agreement.
- Payment of identified deposits as described in the Draft Proposal – as an indication of ‘good faith’ and their intention to comply with the other agreed requirements.

26. What are the two things most travel agencies/tour operators require before they are prepared to proceed with a conference?

- Have a signed contract – in a form approved by management
- AND
- Have received money to use to pay required deposits – as opposed to ‘being promised’ this money.

27. List four activities which follow when the authority to proceed with the Draft Proposal has been given by the client.

- Arrange another meeting/contact with the conference organiser – so the basis for further action can be decided
- Thank them – for approving the Draft Proposal
- Confirm commitment to the event – by confirming the time, resources and effort which will be dedicated to the event
- Determine any last-minute issues – that the conference organiser has identified or has concerns about
- Discuss issues the client wants advice and assistance with – to distinguish topics the conference organiser will handle on their own, and the matters they want help with.

28. What are the four basic options in relation to helping the conference organiser develop a conference program?

- Option 1 – Take the lead: this means being primarily responsible for the program and related decision making
- Option 2 – Hold their hand: this means allowing the conference organiser to take the primary role and assist 'as requested/required' during the planning process
- Option 3 – Take direction: this applies when the conference organiser is extremely skilled, experienced and competent in organising conferences and will simply give instructions which need to be followed/implemented or communicated to suppliers/venues and providers
- Option 4 – Combination of the above: this can apply where the conference organiser knows what they want and what they want to do but need the 'local knowledge' to implement what they want.

29. Name six common format options for conference sessions.

- Workshops
- Plenary sessions
- Break-out sessions
- Parallel sessions
- Talking circles
- Garden sessions
- Key note and support speakers

30. Describe six generic activities involved in developing a conference program.

- Determine format options for the conference
- Determine final structure
- Determine the sequence
- Firm up delegate numbers
- Liaise with providers
- Identify timing and facility requirements
- Confirm catering requirements
- Confirm venues
- Make final decisions

31. Activities inherent in identifying the allocation of facilities to the conference will vary depending on certain factors: name four of these.

- Degree of leadership the conference organiser takes – some of the activities listed will be undertaken by the conference organiser and sometimes the travel agent/tour operator will be expected to do them
- Statements made by both parties – in the initial phase/meetings about what is required in this regard
- Size of the conference – the bigger the conference, the greater the potential need for the travel agent/tour operator to be involved
- Location of the conference – conference organisers from overseas countries generally require/request more in this regard than those who live locally
- Fee charged by the travel agency/tour operator – and the terms and conditions of the contract which exists with the client detailing services to be provided in relation to the conference.

32. Identify six activities involved in identification of facilities for a conference.

- Determining secondary suppliers/venues – who may be involved in service provision/delivery
- Blocking rooms in the numbers required for individual room types – in accommodation facilities for the identified dates
- Booking conference facilities – advising venues in relation to finalised arrangements
- Filing relevant documentation for future reference
- Liaising with client and suppliers/providers
- Advising client of progress.

33. Describe the role of a theme in relation to conducting a conference.

No model answer.

34. Give six 'important factors' relating to the theme/s for a conference.

- The theme (and general concept for the conference) must align with the stated requirements of the client, where stated
- Where a theme is presented to conference organiser it is important to:
 - Explain the features and benefits of the suggestion
 - Show how the suggested theme:
 - Creates a point of difference for the event
 - Aligns with the generic (stated or un-stated) requirements of the organisation and/or the product/service it is trying to promote
 - Generates interest and motivates delegate registrations
 - Demonstrate how the client (or its products/services) will be the focus for the conference – where/if applicable
 - Describe how the theme (and/or concept) will be integrated throughout the conference
- Need to identify examples of:
 - Event integration – describing how the conference will fit in with other promotional activities undertaken by the client organisation
 - Event individualisation – explaining how the unique nature of the conference/program will generate its own 'critical mass'
- Present options – if asked to develop a concept or theme consideration should be given to not just providing *one* theme but providing the client with *three* different options *at three different price points*
- Make suggestions and recommendations for themes – as appropriate:
 - In conjunction with suppliers/providers
 - Using a range of techniques for generating ideas – see below
- Undertake additional site tours of suppliers/providers with the client – so as to:
 - Gain inspiration from the location and/or the facilities, layout
 - Speak to Conference Managers at the venues to obtain their input/suggestions
 - Determine if ideas can be accommodated
- Provide the client with details of previous conferences which have been arranged to give an idea of:
 - Options and potential
 - Popular themes
 - Themes which have already or recently been conducted locally
- Advising the client where themes are unlikely to work
- Include a budget for theming the event.

35. List six strategies to identify ideas for themes for a conference.

- Reviewing the conference brief
- Attending MICE seminars
- Checking on conferences, meetings and conventions held locally/overseas
- Checking on conferences, meetings and conventions to be held in the near future
- Visiting suitable/relevant websites
- Conducting market research surveys
- Participating in industry associations activities
- Participating in trade shows
- Reviewing government statistics
- Reviewing logged feedback
- Reviewing past records from previous meetings and conventions
- Applying a range of different 'creative thinking' techniques.

36. Name four topics which need to be considered when identifying specific requirements for a conference from identified general requirements.

- Quantification of specific materials required
- Identification of specific types of equipment required to support nominated activities and requirements
- Identification of specific brands of products as preferred by the client
- Fine-tuning conference numbers and general conference requirements on the basis of feedback, sales, deposits paid and registrations of interest
- Determining final room set-ups
- Notifying suppliers/providers of information obtained from client.

37. List four practical fundamentals of maintaining on-going liaison with the client/conference organiser.

- Having regular contact with the client/conference organiser
- Be available
- Be proactive
- Take notes
- File all information.

38. Identify two issues which might arise during the planning of a conference and illustrate how each might be a 'positive' and a 'negative' issue.

No model answer.

39. Name four pieces of advice to help deal with issues arising during the planning of a conference.

- Address issues in a promptly
- Be honest
- Communicate
- Be assertive in dealing with issues
- Meet face-to-face with people
- Plan a strategy for dealing with issues

40. Name four generic types of notifications which might need to occur with reference to an upcoming conference.

- Advertising the conference
- Generating, obtaining approval for and issuing media statements
- Organising required additional media-related activities
- Direct mailing of conference material to delegates
- Notifications in relation to required authorisations
- Passing on details to the client on a regular basis
- Contacts received from other organisations
- Progress reports.

41. What are the four main communication options for making notifications with reference to an upcoming conference?

- Online
- Telephone
- Face-to-face
- Hard copies.

42. Give six keys relating to notifications for a conference.

- Honouring promises made about contacts
- Using the option identified by the recipient as being their preferred option
- Developing a schedule to plan notifications which need to be made
- Never being afraid to pick up the phone and speak to the 'relevant other person'
- Being prepared to convene face-to-face meetings as required
- Being careful not to bother (annoy) the conference organiser with trivialities
- Using regular, short communications
- Keeping a copy of all materials distributed – for future reference
- Taking notes
- Integrating issues arising from notifications into action required in the future – to ensure:
 - Appropriate action/responses take place
 - Nothing is overlooked/forgotten
 - Appropriate stakeholders are informed and/or updated
- Assimilating *confirmations* received as a result of the notifications into future activities – in relation to:
 - Taking the next step in the identified sequence of tasks/activities required
 - Revising plans and programs as/if required
 - Updating stakeholders
- Reviewing the existing notification protocols – to:
 - Combine lessons learned into future action/notifications
 - Better respond to stakeholders
 - Achieve a more effective and expedient outcome.

43. Name four generic activities involved in arranging for facilities to be available for a client/conference.

- Double-checking with venues and suppliers/providers – to:
 - Required dates and times have been blocked for/allocated to the conference – and there has been no double booking of rooms, facilities or venues
 - Ensure they are aware of all the requirements for the conference program – as already communicated
 - Verify all identified requirements have been covered
- Liaising with client and providers/suppliers – to:
 - Facilitate inspection of supplier warehouses, products and general infrastructure needed to support the conference
 - Organise inspection of conference rooms/facilities
 - Enable inspections of accommodation venues and rooms
 - Obtain copies of product catalogue/service menu as appropriate
 - Determine and negotiate final prices
 - Allow conference organiser to:
 - Attend other functions conducted by venues/supported by providers
 - Talk to other conference organisers who have experience with the identified venues/suppliers
- Assisting client with their plans – relating to:
 - Deciding on room layouts and set-ups
 - Finalising the position of items within conference rooms and identified venues
 - Organising set up of displays and exhibitions
 - Identifying supporting infrastructure required
 - Communicating with key personnel inside venues/supplier organisations
 - Monitoring progress preparations for the conference
- Arranging for client to experience and sample the facilities, services and products of the suppliers/providers – including:
 - Provision of complementary meals
 - Comp stays at accommodation venues
 - Taste testing of food/drinks
 - Experiencing/auditioning entertainment
 - Meeting with businesses and/or individuals who will provide identified services/expertise
- Finalising numbers – for:
 - Accommodation
 - Catering
 - Conference events/inclusions

- Confirming dates and times – for all identified aspects of the conference program as agreed with the conference organiser
- Verifying stated requirements – as discussed with the client to the best possible with all involved venues and/or providers
- Negotiating, obtaining, reading and signing contracts – if required, with necessary:
 - Oversight from a legal practitioner
 - Authority from all designated managers
- Making payments as required – for:
 - Initial deposits
 - Progress payments
 - Final payments

Obtaining binding confirmation – in hard copy form which can be used as proof of payment and/or evidence of the other party's commitment

44. Identify four points which need to be afforded due attention in relation to preparing a Final Proposal and quotation for a conference.

- Use a team approach
- Allocate sufficient resources to this vital stage
- Base the content of the Final Proposal on three primary factors:
 - Content and intention of the Draft Proposal
 - Identified need for the conference program – as revealed during discussions with the conference organiser
 - Input from and constraints imposed by venues, providers and suppliers
- Understand the development of a Final Proposal is a time-consuming and complex undertaking – and:
 - Will take some time to complete
 - Is a critical phase of the process:
 - All the work already invested in the conference may be for nothing if this Proposal is not accepted
 - Future revenue for the travel agency/tour operator hinges on acceptance of this document
- Refer previous Final Proposals and quotations which have been successful – as:
 - A model for layout and presentation
 - An example of wording and ordering of materials
- Check and double-check all content – to make sure:
 - All required elements are covered
 - Statistics, dates, times, amounts, volumes, numbers and prices are correct
 - Arithmetic calculations are correct
 - Management has approved the Final Draft and quotation for release.

- Set a date with the client for submission of the Final Proposal – and ensure:
 - This date is met
 - Multiple copies are prepared and presented to the conference organiser for their consideration
 - Arrangements are made to allow a formal presentation and explanation of the Draft Proposal in a face-to-face setting
 - The Final Draft and quotation is kept and filed.
45. Name six activities and content which are indicative of what may need to be involved in developing and submitting a Final Proposal for a conference.
- Specify the goals and objectives for the conference
 - Describe the final conference program for the event
 - Identify the support/human resources to support the program
 - Finalise budgets for the event
 - Prepare necessary plans for the conference
 - Set up a suitable monitoring system for the event
 - Create the required supporting and ancillary documentation
 - Submit the Final Proposal to the client/conference organiser.
46. Provide six examples of important background advice in relation to negotiating finalisation of the contract/conference with a client/conference organiser.
- Stay positive, maintain focus and remain enthusiastic – about the project
 - Be available – when and as needed
 - Respond to queries – as they are made
 - Meet with the prospect/client
 - Provide extra detail/information as requested
 - Avoid showing frustration – with the client, the conference, the time things are taking, the extra detail requested
 - Keep in touch with venue/s and providers – to keep them up-to-date with what is/is not happening
 - Avoid appearing desperate – the more the travel agency/tour operator appears desperate for the conference (by action such as ‘chasing’ the client/ conference organiser for a decision), the easier it will be for them to negotiate ‘down’ (ask for lower prices and/or demand more in the way of products, services, inclusions).

47. Give six examples of strategies which might be employed to secure a conference.

- Meeting with client/conference organiser – to present and discuss the Final Proposal and quotation
- Facilitating visits to suggested/tentative venues and supplies – for inspections to view facilities, meetings with management/staff, taste tests, attendance as observers at other conferences being held
- Clarifying doubts the client/conference organiser may have – about elements of the plans and proposal submitted
- Collaborating and advising on other projects or matters of concern to the client/conference organiser – to give them more value-for-money as a result of the arrangement
- Discussing foreseeable issues – which demonstrates flexibility and willingness to respond positively to issues raised.

The more time spent talking with the client/conference organiser, the more they start to see they can work with the business and the more they start to believe 'together' any problem which crops up can be solved.

- Following up on proposal submitted – by undertaking a range of activities already referred to:
 - Providing extra detail and information
 - Clarifying ambiguities
 - Providing site visits and taste tests
 - Providing examples of all inclusions – music, entertainers shows, trips, visits, inclusions
 - Making a personal presentation
- Keeping client/conference organiser updated on developments – as they may change in this gap/period between 'the last meeting' and the submission of the Final Proposal through emails, telephone calls or face-to-face meetings.
- Negotiating a final deal – which can include the need to:
 - Identify and be able to suggest substitutions and alternatives for items deemed by the conference organiser to be inappropriate or too expensive
 - Pre-determine responses to anticipated 'buying objections'
 - Know the scope of authority for making changes to prices, costs and quotes as well as products and services offered/contained in the Final Proposal
 - Plan the tactics to be used during the negotiation
 - Achieve a win-win situation
 - Identify the price below which the project will not be accepted
 - Identify and practice closing strategies

- Value-adding – the options here may include:
 - Extending the client/conference organiser an invitation to certain private/industry events as an incentive
 - Providing networking sessions and potentially useful ‘introductions’ to the conference organiser
 - Providing ‘free’ (promotional) merchandise and other tangible ‘management-level’ gifts such as diaries/compendiums, in accordance with business SOPs in this regard.
48. What are the two keys to obtaining binding confirmation of a conference from a conference organiser?
- Getting the client/conference organiser to sign a contract
 - Obtaining payment of a deposit.
49. What are four possible ancillary issues which might need to be addressed when confirming conference details with a venue/provider?
- Following instances where simple verbal or SMS notification/confirmation only is given in the immediate ‘first instance’ to venues/suppliers with electronic or hard copy evidence of same
 - Ensuring deposits have been paid
 - Making sure known details of the conference are communicated
 - Scheduling a first meeting
 - Advising relevant personnel in relation to next steps to be taken regarding implementation of the conference
 - Finalising options identified as possible choices
 - Seeking verification all bookings that have been made are confirmed
 - Highlighting potential issues
 - Maintaining and building the relationship with other businesses

50. Describe four keys to beginning action in relation to a conference which has been approved by a conference organiser.

- Keep promises made to the conference organiser – as made verbally and as contained in contractual form
 - Follow the plans – which were prepared for the conference:
 - Distribute and explain copies of plans to relevant others who need to use/follow/implement them
 - Revise plans where targets, objectives, timelines are not achieved
 - It is vital not to allow things to fall behind schedule
 - Notify all the venues and providers – and other third parties involved in preparations for and delivery of the conference:
 - Formally advise them the conference is going ahead.
 - Convert tentative arrangements into confirmed booking/reservations.
 - Pay holding/booking deposits
 - Monitor action taken – according to plans:
 - Take notes of observations/issues to record the detail and assist with resolution
 - Be prepared to take remedial action where needed
 - Realise nothing ever seems to go 100% as planned
 - Be visible – make sure others know their work/progress is being monitored
 - Communicate – on a regular basis with:
 - Client/conference organiser – to:
 - Advise of progress and provide feedback
 - Check for issues arising
 - Obtain direction about what to do when problems need to be resolved
 - Venues and providers – to:
 - Ensure conformity to what was promised/arranged and what is required
 - Provide information to assist with preparation and set-up
 - Update them as numbers firm up
 - Notify of last minute changes/requirements
 - Check/inspect work done.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Develop conference programs D2.TCS.CL5.09
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Meet with conference organiser - Plan the conference program in conjunction with the client - Finalise conference program - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Meet with conference organiser		
Identify timing requirements for conference	☐	☐
Determine type, context and scope for conference	☐	☐
Determine budget for the conference	☐	☐
Determine catering needs for the conference	☐	☐
Determine accommodation needs for the conference	☐	☐
Determine if the conference can be accommodated	☐	☐
Submit draft proposal and indicative quotation to client	☐	☐
Book the conference with suitable suppliers and service providers	☐	☐
Element 2: Plan the conference program in conjunction with the client		
Assist client to develop conference format	☐	☐
Identify allocation of facilities to the conference	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Assist in developing theme for the conference	☐	☐
Identify specific requirements from identified general requirements	☐	☐
Maintain on-going liaison with client	☐	☐
Address issues arising in the planning of the conference	☐	☐
Determine notifications for the conference	☐	☐
Arrange for venue facilities to be available to the client	☐	☐
Element 3: Finalise conference program		
Develop and submit final proposal and quotation	☐	☐
Negotiate finalisation of the conference with client	☐	☐
Obtain binding confirmation of the conference from the client	☐	☐
Confirm conference details with suppliers and providers	☐	☐
Begin activities in accordance with approved proposal/plan	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest		
Unit of competency:	Develop conference programs D2.TCS.CL5.09		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response)</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Meets with conference organisers to determine all requirements and parameters for conferences	☐	☐	☐
Prepares and submits draft proposals and quotations to client	☐	☐	☐
Books conference requirements with suitable third party suppliers and service providers	☐	☐	☐
Assists client with planning format and theme for conferences	☐	☐	☐
Identifies and addresses conference issues	☐	☐	☐
Liaises with clients and suppliers/providers on an ongoing basis	☐	☐	☐
Finalises conference program including achieving and obtaining final binding confirmation and payment	☐	☐	☐
Initiates action to begin conference	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Develop conference programs	D2.TCS.CL5.09
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Meet with conference organiser						
Identify timing requirements for conference						
Determine type, context and scope for conference						
Determine budget for the conference						
Determine catering needs for the conference						
Determine accommodation needs for the conference						
Determine if the conference can be accommodated						
Submit draft proposal and indicative quotation to client						
Book the conference with suitable suppliers and service providers						
Element 2: Plan the conference program in conjunction with the client						
Assist client to develop conference format						
Identify allocation of facilities to the conference						
Assist in developing theme for the conference						
Identify specific requirements from identified general requirements						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Maintain on-going liaison with client						
Address issues arising in the planning of the conference						
Determine notifications for the conference						
Arrange for venue facilities to be available to the client						
Element 3: Finalise conference program						
Develop and submit final proposal and quotation						
Negotiate finalisation of the conference with client						
Obtain binding confirmation of the conference from the client						
Confirm conference details with suppliers and providers						
Begin activities in accordance with approved proposal/plan						
Candidate signature:			Date:			
Assessor signature:			Date:			

